

Stamford House Website

Master Context Document & Build Brief - everything an unfamiliar assistant needs to continue this project. Generated June 2026.

ONE-LINE SUMMARY: A static, dark-first, animation-rich marketing/community website for Stamford House at Altrincham Grammar School for Boys (AGSB), featuring a live, filterable house-events calendar. Plain HTML/CSS/JS - no build step. Lives on the main branch of GitHub repo dm-tuition/stamford-1.

1. What this project is

- ? Purpose: Public/internal site for Stamford House - promote the house, show its identity & legacy, list the year's competitions, and let students get involved.
- ? Audience: Stamford students (all year groups), prospective members, the wider AGBS community.
- ? Owner/contact: dmtuition2026@gmail.com. Built for the 2026/27 Stamford leadership (Captain Daniel Stevenson, Vice Captain Ayaan Siddiqui).
- ? Repo: dm-tuition/stamford-1 | Branch: main (everything committed and pushed here).

2. Tech stack & architecture

- ? Pure static site - no framework, no build, no package manager. Just HTML + CSS + vanilla JS.
- ? Fonts: Google Fonts - Space Grotesk (display/headings) + Inter (body).
- ? No external JS libraries - all animation/interactivity is hand-written vanilla JS (works offline, zero dependencies).
- ? Data-driven calendar: the Events page fetches data/events.json at runtime and renders it.
[NOTE] IMPORTANT GOTCHA: because the calendar uses fetch(), the site must be served over HTTP, not opened via file://. Locally run: python3 -m http.server 8000 then visit http://localhost:8000. All other pages work from file://; only the calendar needs a server.

3. File structure

index.html:

Home - animated hero, marquee, stats, house scoreboard, ethos, events preview, captain spotlight, quote carousel, CTA.

about.html:

Identity, ethos grid, legacy timeline (2019->2026/27), colour palette.

leadership.html:

Captains + spotlight, house leadership structure, full Senior Prefect Team (all four houses).

events.html:

Live events calendar: countdown, season stats, search, type/year filters, grid/list toggle, jump-to-month, .ics download.

gallery.html:

'A season in blue' - masonry photo grid (placeholder tiles for now).

get-involved.html:

Three ways in, contact form (floating labels), copy-email chip, FAQ accordion, sponsor.

404.html:

Custom not-found page.

css/style.css:

The entire design system + all component styles + flair layer + responsive + reduced-motion.

js/main.js:

Global behaviours (see section 6). Loaded on every page.

js/events.js:

Calendar engine - load/render/filter/search/ics/countdown. Loaded on events.html only.

data/events.json:

88 house events for 2025/26 (the live data source).

assets/crest.png:

PRIMARY crest - refined gold-framed transparent PNG. Used site-wide.

assets/crest.svg:

Vector fallback crest (older, flat).

assets/crest-photo.jpeg:

Original crest photo with stone background (source reference / secondary fallback).

assets/photos/:

Drop captain portraits (daniel.jpg, ayaan.jpg) + gallery images here.

README.md, CLAUDE.md:

Repo readme + the brand/school context master prompt.

4. Design system

Palette (CSS variables in :root)

- ? Royal #2a4bff - Royal-bright #4d6bff - Steel #2f8fd0 - Cyan #6fd6ff - Light #d8e9f5.
- ? Dark surfaces: bg #04081e, bg-2 #070d2a; text #eaf0ff, muted #93a4cf.
- ? Dark-first with a light theme via `html[data-theme='light']`, toggled by the sun/moon button (persisted in localStorage key 'stamford-theme').
- ? No rival-house colours in the brand (red=Bradbury, green=Massey, yellow=Tatton). They appear only in the flag strip and the Senior Prefect Team cards.

Key reusable classes

.glass (frosted card), .card, .btn .btn--primary/.btn--ghost, .section, .eyebrow, .section-title, .gradient-text, .reveal (+ .d1/.d2/.d3 stagger), .split, .grid .grid-2/3/4, .spotlight, .person, .scoreboard, .timeline, .cta-band, [data-tilt], [data-spy].

5. The crest / logo system

- ? Every crest `<img>` uses `src='assets/crest.png'` with onerror fallback to `assets/crest-photo.jpeg`. Favicon points to `assets/crest.png`.
 - ? To change the crest: replace `assets/crest.png` (transparent PNG recommended). Updates nav, hero, footers, captain badges, preloader and favicon at once.
 - ? Hero crest size is set in CSS: `.hero-crest img { width: min(480px, 86vw) }`.
- [NOTE] HISTORY: the crest went flat SVG -> textured photo -> background-removed cutout -> refined gold-framed enamel PNG. The current/approved one is the refined gold-framed transparent PNG at `assets/crest.png`.

6. JavaScript features

js/main.js (every page)

- ? Preloader (crest + load bar, centered), film-grain overlay, skip-to-content link, focus-visible.
- ? Light/dark theme toggle (persisted); mobile nav; footer year auto-fill.
- ? Scroll-progress bar; header hides on scroll-down / shows on scroll-up.
- ? Custom glowing cursor; magnetic buttons; 3D crest tilt; card tilt ([data-tilt]).
- ? Scroll-reveal (IntersectionObserver); count-up numbers; animated scoreboard bars.
- ? Particle 'starfield' canvas; drifting background orbs in heroes.
- ? Flair: floating per-letter hero wordmark; letter-by-letter heading reveals; flowing gradient text; glare sweep on cards/buttons; blue sparkle burst on primary buttons / theme toggle / flagship cards.
- ? Quote carousel; scroll-spy dots (from [data-spy] sections on home); page-transition curtain.
- ? Global helpers: `window.stamfordToast(msg, icon)`, `window.stamfordSparkle(x,y,count)`, `window.stamfordCountUp(el)`.

? Everything respects prefers-reduced-motion (animations disabled / instant).

js/events.js (events.html)

- ? Fetches data/events.json; renders cards grouped by month.
- ? Filters: type (Sport / Academic / Arts / Performance / Social) with live counts, and year group.
- ? Live text search; grid/list view toggle; jump-to-month nav.
- ? Countdown to the next dated event (relative to today).
- ? 'Add to calendar' generates a downloadable .ics per dated event.
- ? Season stats computed live (totals by category, months).

7. Events data model (data/events.json)

Top-level: meta, categories (array), events (array). Each event has:

title:

Event name (flagship House Shout marked with flagship: true).

staff:

Staff lead / organiser.

date:

ISO date (YYYY-MM-DD) or null if TBC. Drives countdown + .ics.

dateLabel:

Human label shown on the card (e.g. 'Thu 16 Oct', 'Feb - May', 'TBC').

month:

Group header (e.g. 'October 2025'). Sept-Dec = 2025, Jan-Jul = 2026.

yearGroup, number:

Who it's for, and participant count/notes.

ethos:

Array of tag words.

notes:

Free-text details.

category:

One of the 5 categories (drives filtering + colour).

Transcribed from the school's '25-26 Events' PDF (Annual House Events Calendar 2025/26): ~88 rows across Sept 2025 -> Jul 2026. Flagship events include House Shout (Oct); the season ends with Sports Days (30 Jun / 1 Jul).

[TODO] DATA CAVEAT: a few cells in the source PDF looked column-shifted (some cricket 'Year group/Number' values). Transcribed as-shown rather than guessed - worth a human check. Also the source's 'December 2024' header is treated as Dec 2025.

8. Brand & voice (from CLAUDE.md)

- ? School: Altrincham Grammar School for Boys (AGSB), Hamblin Education Trust. Motto: Labor Omnia Vincit ('Work Conquers All').
- ? Houses: Bradbury (red), Massey (green), Stamford (blue), Tatton (yellow). Reintroduced 2019.
- ? Stamford identity: the dominant house - collaborative, high-achieving, inclusive. ~5-6 years of House Shout dominance; 'two thirds of the trophy cabinet is blue'. Ethos: every student has a role; mass participation wins.
- ? Voice: confident, direct, inclusive, legacy-aware, warm from leadership. Avoid corporate filler and committee-speak.

Leadership 2026/27

House Captain - Daniel Stevenson:

Y13. Volleyball club founder, football & hockey, co-directs Finance Society. A-levels: Further Maths, Maths, Physics, Economics. Aiming for Finance at Oxbridge.

Vice Captain - Ayaan Siddiqui:

Y13. Co-founder of 'AyaanDanShenanigans' endurance charity brand.

Head Prefect - Julian Bendon:

Across-school role.

Other houses 2026/27 - Bradbury: Aadith Menon / Panchu Nucherla; Massey: Soorian Jegatheeswaran / Gregory Singh; Tatton: Edward Aloul / Anthony Ononye. Sponsor: ABC+ Warranty (architectscertificate.co.uk).

9. How to run & deploy

- ? Local: `python3 -m http.server 8000` in the repo root, then `http://localhost:8000`.
- ? Deploy: any static host. Recommended GitHub Pages (serve main at root) - not yet set up. Netlify/Vercel also work with zero config.
- ? Git workflow: commit + push to main. (Earlier work used branch `claude/website-first-draft-87H4Y`, since merged.)

10. Outstanding / future work (TO DO)

- [TODO] Captain photos: add `assets/photos/daniel.jpg` & `ayaan.jpg` - they auto-replace the initials placeholders.
- [TODO] Gallery images: replace the placeholder tiles in `gallery.html` with real event photos.
- [TODO] Contact form: currently a demo (shows a toast, no send). Wire to the real house inbox via Formspree or similar. Replace placeholder email `stamford.house@agsb.co.uk`.
- [TODO] Live house scores: the home scoreboard is illustrative - wire to a real data source if available.
- [TODO] Go live: set up GitHub Pages (or other host) for a public URL.
- [TODO] Verify event data with the school (the column-shift caveat in section 7).
- [TODO] Optional flair not yet built: typewriter/scramble tagline, 3D flip captain cards, scroll-speed parallax, hero video loop.

11. Editing cheat-sheet

Add/edit an event:

`data/events.json` (add an object to 'events').

Swap the crest:

Replace `assets/crest.png`.

Resize hero crest:

`.hero-crest` img width in `css/style.css`.

Change colours/fonts:

:root variables in `css/style.css`.

Edit nav links:

`.nav-links` list - in the header of every `.html` page (kept in sync manually).

Add a page:

Copy an existing page's header/footer, add to nav on all pages, include `js/main.js`.

This document is a portable context brief for the Stamford House website. Hand it (or its contents) to any new assistant/session to bring them fully up to speed. - June 2026.